

BEFORE

Christianity survived the fall of Rome and prospered. Christian Europe expanded, and Church and State became intertwined.

SURVIVAL OF THE LATIN CHURCH

The decline of the Western Roman Empire and the **influx of barbarian peoples** in the 4th–6th centuries CE did not spell the end for Christianity in Western Europe. Many of the Germanic tribes were **Arian Christians**, a variant of Christianity at odds with Roman doctrine. Others, such as the Franks, entered as **pagans** but were **converted to Christianity**. Throughout the lands of the Roman Empire in Western Europe, Latin Christianity survived and, by the 6th–7th centuries, had **triumphed over Arianism**.

From the late 6th century under Pope Gregory the Great, and throughout the 7th–10th centuries, **Christian missionaries** began to spread Latin Christianity into the remaining pagan areas of Europe, such as Anglo-Saxon England, Denmark, and the Slavic territories of Central Europe.

THE EAST–WEST SCHISM

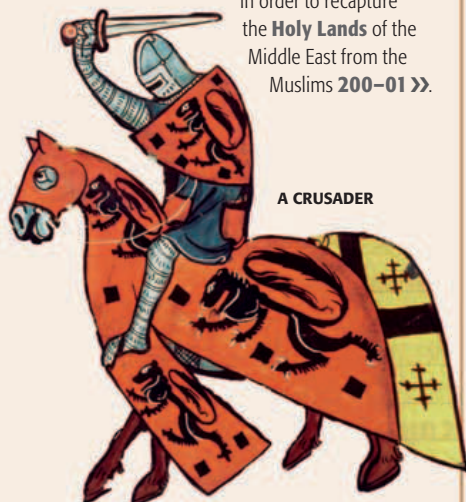
Long after the collapse of the Western Empire, the **Roman Empire in the East** continued to thrive **198–99 >>**. The Eastern Church under the **Patriarch of Constantinople** became gradually more estranged from the Latin Church, culminating in the **Great Schism of 1054**.

THE IMPERIAL CHURCH

Under the emperor **Charlemagne << 194–95** church and state enjoyed a **close relationship**. Charlemagne made the church central to his government, using clerics as teachers and administrators, and used the spiritual authority of the church to **enhance his own authority** as emperor and defender of Christianity. In 800 he was **crowned by the pope** in Rome. This policy was adopted by other secular rulers such as the German emperor **Otto I << 195–96** who used his influence over the appointment of clerics to strengthen his own authority at the expense of the nobility.

THE FIRST CRUSADE

By 1095, Christian Europe felt confident enough to mount a **military campaign** outside Europe in order to recapture the **Holy Lands** of the Middle East from the Muslims **200–01 >>**.



A CRUSADER

The Power and the Glory

Medieval Western Europe was dominated by a common religious culture. Under a series of strong-willed, reform-minded popes, the Church became more centralized, powerful, and assertive. But over time, the Church also grew increasingly intolerant and politically divided.

At the start of the 11th century, Western Europe was emerging from a long period of raids by tribes outside its borders, including Vikings from the north (see pp.202–03), Muslims from the south (see pp.174–75), and pagan Magyars from the Eurasian steppes. By 1000 CE the worst of the raids were over and Latin Christendom ceased

to feel on the defensive. Freed from the threat of pagan and Muslim aggressors, the Church grew more prosperous, self-confident, and assertive.

The church reform movement

With this increasing confidence came a desire for reform. This impulse was felt first in the monasteries, which had

served as an important repository for Christian learning and observance during the previous centuries. Prior to the 11th century, individual monasteries spread across Europe tended to follow their own interpretations of the monastic rule, often under the control of secular lords and benefactors. The reform movement centered on the Burgundian

The monk in the white habit may represent Bernard of Clairvaux, abbot of the reformed Cistercian order.

An unidentified bishop wears a pallium, a yoke-shaped band of white wool, embroidered with crosses.

A senior cardinal (Niccolo Albertini di Prato) stands at the right hand of the pope in his broad-brimmed cardinal's hat.

Pope Benedict XI dominates the piece—as pope he is God's representative on earth and the supreme spiritual authority.



Several nuns wear the black and white habit of the Dominicans; others wear Franciscan and Carmelite habits.

Priests and monks from the Augustinian, Benedictine, Carmelite, Dominican, and Franciscan orders are shown engaged in prayers and debate.

The sheep symbolize the pope's human flock and are guarded by black and white dogs that represent the Dominican order—a play on the phrase *Domini canes*, Latin for "Lord's hounds."